

YOUR FULL REPORT

Are you being a bad friend?

The balance is off

Score band: 27–35 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A practical rebalancing plan for friendships that may be revolving too often around your needs or moods.

Inside:

1. Signs the give-and-take is off
2. Listening and follow-through practices
3. How to address tension directly

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Your result

The balance is off (27–35 points)

Your answers suggest that your friendships may sometimes revolve around your needs, moods, or convenience. That can change through smaller, repeated acts of consideration.

Try this next

Ask yourself before reaching out: 'Am I also making room for what is happening with them?'

Your practical guide

A practical rebalancing plan for friendships that may be revolving too often around your needs or moods.

1 Signs the give-and-take is off

An off-balance friendship usually shows the same symptoms: conversations revolve around your news, your crises, your schedule; you realize you cannot name what is happening in their life right now; plans happen on your terms and they accommodate; or you feel a vague guilt you keep postponing. None of this makes you a bad person — it makes you an inattentive one, which is fixable. The diagnostic question is simple: if the friendship ended tomorrow, would they say they felt known by you? Answer it honestly for each close friendship. The ones where the answer is uncomfortable are your repair list.

2 Listening and follow-through practices

Rebalance with two practices. First, the 50/50 conversation rule: in your next three catch-ups, deliberately ask about their life first and follow up twice before sharing your news. You will be surprised how much you have been missing — and how good it feels to know. Second, the unprompted follow-through: text about the thing they mentioned ("how did the dentist go?"), remember the date that matters to them, offer help before they ask. These are not grand gestures; they are proof of attention, which is the actual currency of friendship. Track it for a month: after each interaction, note whether you learned something new about them.

3 How to address tension directly

If tension has been building, address it directly instead of letting it calcify. Use the friendship version of a clean conversation: "I have felt some distance between us lately, and I value you too much to let it sit. Is there something I have been missing?" Then listen without defending — the goal is information, not acquittal. If they name something real, own your part specifically and ask what would help. If the tension is mostly your guilt projecting, saying so out loud often dissolves it. Directness feels risky, but friendships rarely die from one honest conversation; they die from fifty avoided ones.